BILL ATHANASSIOU

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Hiring Manager
Community Health Service
Hunter New England Local Health District
Tamworth NSW 2340

Re: Public Health Officer, Community Health Service, Tamworth

Dear Hiring Manager,

I am a final-year student at the University of Sydney, applying for the Public Health Officer position with the Community Health Service in Tamworth. Hunter New England is the only NSW health district that spans a major city, large regional centres and remote communities, so its vision of building healthier communities depends on reaching people far from the nearest service. Around Tamworth, that can mean a long drive to see a specialist. Two of my main project experiences in HSBH2009 centred on older Australians who miss out on care because of age or distance, and I would bring that focus to health promotion in the district.

Working effectively as part of a diverse team, as well as independently, was central to our Design Project. I researched two solutions and drafted Sections 1 and 2, including an assessment of our target population's needs. My teammate developed the slide sequence, and I added animations and narration to our community health video. Our marker described it as “an engaging presentation” and singled out its advice to ask a pharmacist about medication packs as “particularly effective for the intended audience”. This experience would inform how I conduct community health assessments and collaborate with local stakeholders, combining their community knowledge with my research and communication skills.

A simulated telehealth consultation showed me where my communication and interpersonal skills needed work. When the patient's foot slipped out of view, I paused my explanation and guided her camera positioning before continuing. That taught me to check understanding before moving on, an approach I would bring to developing and implementing health promotion initiatives in Tamworth. I would also engage in health advocacy by supporting phone or face-to-face alternatives for people unable to participate by video. Letting people choose how they take part is how I would show the district's values of respect and empowerment.

My proficiency in the use of technology for enhancing health came through partly in the Week 9 Media Lab, where I designed two simulated patients and built and tested one of them, Ethan, in Simu Talk. His responses followed the instructions I had written for practising open questions and explaining confidentiality. In Week 6, I tested an AI scribe on a mock consultation and checked its note against what was actually said. Finding a date the patient never gave taught me that technology is successfully implemented in new organisations only when staff check its output. I would apply that approach when helping services monitor and evaluate health outcomes, checking accuracy alongside workload and patient experience.

The district's values of collaboration and openness would guide that work through shared decisions with local partners and clear explanations of technology's limitations. The attached ePortfolio sets out the evidence against each criterion. I am available to start immediately, and I would welcome the chance to discuss how I could support health promotion and community health assessment in Tamworth.

Yours sincerely,

Bill Athanassiou